

# XLP

## Excel Learning Projects
## Quick Start Guide

# Contents

1. Getting Started ..... 3
2. Concepts ..... 6
   2.1 Card Types ..... 6
   2.2 Learning Profiles ..... 6
   2.3 Customization ..... 6
3. Tips and Tricks ..... 7
   3.1 Learning Progress ..... 7
   3.2 Undo and Redo ..... 7
   3.3 Corrections ..... 7
   3.4 Merge ..... 8
   3.5 Headers ..... 8
   3.6 Topics ..... 9

# 1. Getting Started

XLP is a simple flashcard application. This Quick Start Guide introduces its most important features.

A flashcard looks like this in the learning view:

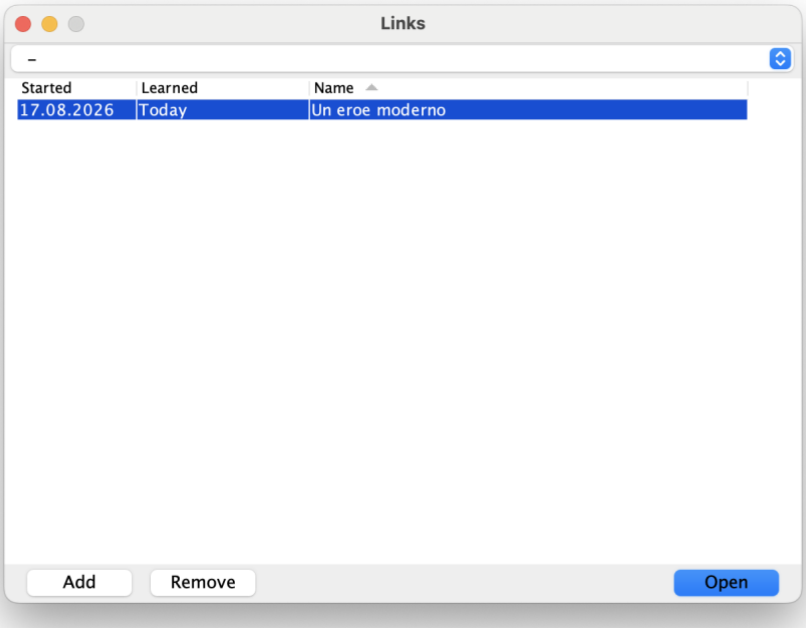



Here, you are asked for the Italian word corresponding to the German adjective "fleißig". You think of the answer and turn the card over by pressing **Space**. If you knew the answer, press **Enter** to continue to the next card; otherwise, press **Space**.

The learning content is managed in Excel workbooks. In the simplest case, enter the foreign language in column A and your own language in column B, or vice versa:

| | A | B | C |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | studioso, -a | fleißig | |
| 2 | da tanto | seit langem | |
| 3 | abottonato, -a | zugeknöpft | |
| 4 | socchiuso, -a | halbgeschlossen | |
| 5 | Giunone | Juno | |
| 6 | di bell'aspetto | gutaussehend | |
| 7 | il camposanto | Friedhof | |
| 8 | bardare | herausputzen | |
| 9 | essere in lutto | Trauer tragen | |
| 10 | il quindicenne | der Fünfzehnjährige | |

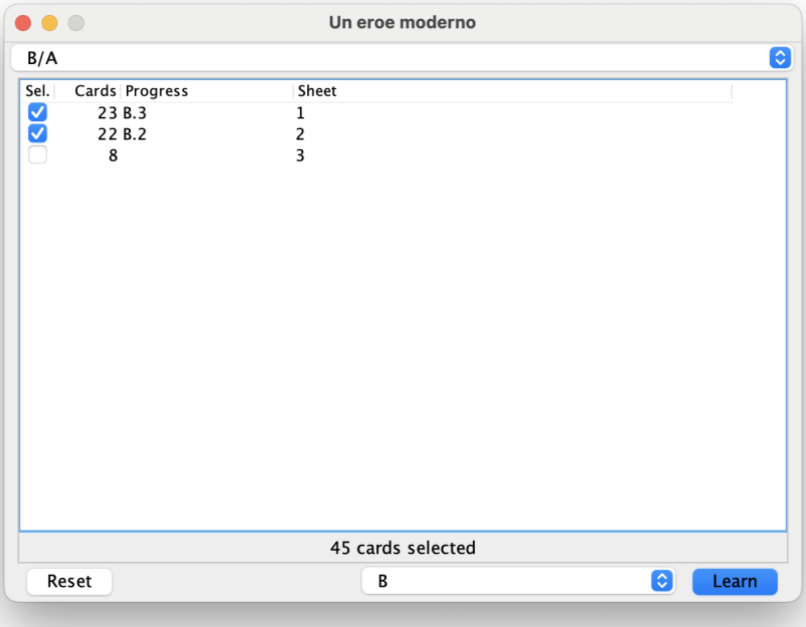
The Excel workbooks are linked to the application. When you start XLP for the first time, the link list view is displayed:




Here you have the following options:

- **Add**: Link an Excel workbook
- **Remove**: Delete the selected link (the Excel workbook itself is not deleted)
- **Open**: Open the selected link

When you open a link, the project view is displayed:




Here you can:

- Select the learning direction
- Select the sheets to learn
- Select a learning profile (see 2.2)

Click **Learn** to open the learning view described above.

Close the windows or press **Esc** to return to the project view and the link list view. In any view, you can quit the application by pressing **⌘Q**. When you start XLP again, it returns to the same place.

# 2. Concepts

## 2.1 Card Types

The learning directions A/B and B/A are predefined card types. However, you can also define your own card types, for example for tables containing verb forms.

## 2.2 Learning Profiles

A learning profile is a training program that allows you to improve your knowledge in successive steps. Learning profile B, for example, has five steps, B.1 to B.5, or * to *****.

For the transition from B.3 to B.4, the condition 2/2 (2 out of 2) is defined. For an individual card, this means that two consecutive tests must be positive.

The overall rating is calculated as the average of the individual ratings.

The following table describes the predefined learning profiles:

| Learning profile | Description | Steps | Conditions |
|---|---|---|---|
| A | Start, easy | 5 | 1/1, 1/1, 1/1, 1/1, 1/1 |
| B | Start, medium | 5 | 1/1, 1/1, 1/1, 2/2, 3/3 |
| C | Start, hard | 5 | 1/1, 2/2, 3/3, 4/4, 5/5 |
| R1 | First repetition | 3 | 1/1, 1/1, 1/1 |
| R2 | Second repetition | 3 | 1/1, 1/1, 1/1 |
| R3 | Third repetition | 3 | 1/1, 1/1, 1/1 |

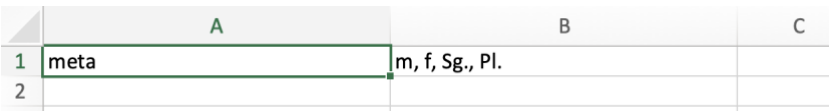
If needed, you can also define your own learning profiles.

Learning progress is stored separately for each learning profile.

## 2.3 Customization

Card types, learning profiles, and many other aspects can be customized if needed. A fundamental principle of XLP is that these customizations are not global, but local to each Excel workbook. They are defined on a separate sheet named ".INI".

For example, the following line causes the abbreviations m, f, Sg., and Pl. to be highlighted on the cards:




If you need customizations, you should use Excel templates that provide the appropriate customizations for each context.

# 3. Tips and Tricks

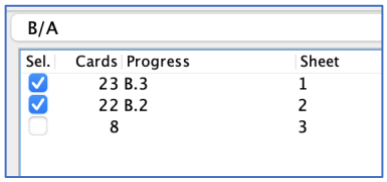
## 3.1 Learning Progress

The learning view displays the learning progress in the status bar:




- Left: Number of cards
- Center: Current step of the learning profile
- Right: Number of cards that still need to be improved in the current step

The project view displays the progress for each sheet and each learning profile that has been started:




Click **Reset** to reset the progress for the selected sheets and the selected learning profile.

## 3.2 Undo and Redo

While learning, you can press **⌘Z** to undo actions and **⌘Y** to redo undone actions.

Press **Tab** to turn the displayed card over.

## 3.3 Corrections

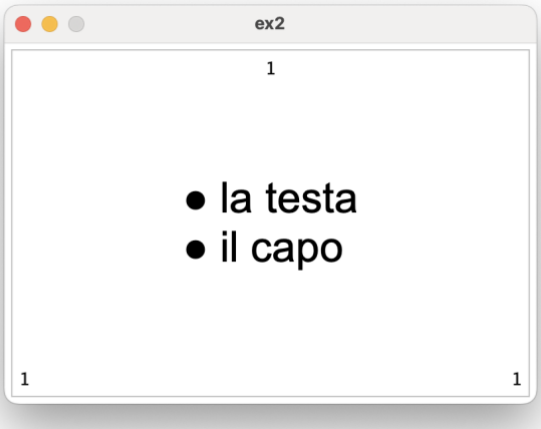
If you notice an error on a card while learning, press **⌘E** to open the Excel workbook and correct the error. After saving the workbook and returning to the learning view, the display should update accordingly.

The **⌘E** shortcut works in every view.

## 3.4 Merge

By default, cards with the same front are merged across sheets. Duplicates are ignored:

| | A | B | C |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | la testa | Kopf | |
| 2 | il capo | Kopf | |
| 3 | il capo | Kopf | |



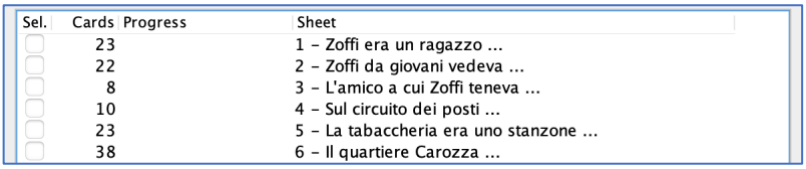

## 3.5 Headers

You can use headers:

| | A | B | C |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Zoffi era un ragazzo ...** | | |
| 2 | **Italienisch** | **Deutsch** | |
| 3 | studioso, -a | fleißig | |
| 4 | da tanto | seit langem | |
| 5 | abottonato, -a | zugeknöpft | |

The header rows must be frozen using **View | Freeze Panes**. The text in cell A1 is used as the title of the sheet. As in the example, you can merge cells A1 and B1.

In the project view, the sheet name (here, "1") is supplemented by the title:



| Sel. | Cards | Progress | Sheet |
|---|---|---|---|
| ☐ | 23 | | 1 – Zoffi era un ragazzo ... |
| ☐ | 22 | | 2 – Zoffi da giovani vedeva ... |
| ☐ | 8 | | 3 – L'amico a cui Zoffi teneva ... |
| ☐ | 10 | | 4 – Sul circuito dei posti ... |
| ☐ | 23 | | 5 – La tabaccheria era uno stanzone ... |
| ☐ | 38 | | 6 – Il quartiere Carozza ... |

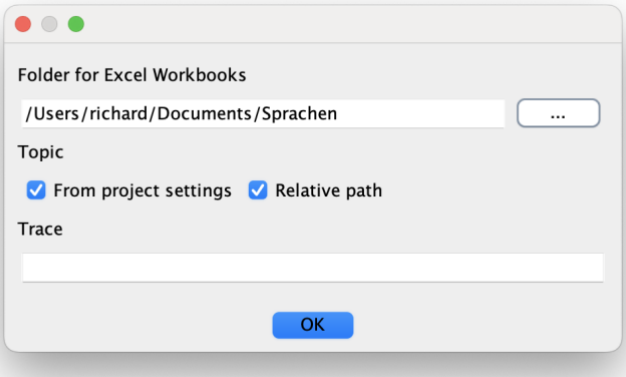
For workbooks containing many sheets, short names such as 1, 2, 3, etc. make navigation easier.

When a vocabulary list is complete, you can use an end marker to prevent accidentally entering new vocabulary:

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 23 | entrarci | mit etw. zu tun haben | |
| 24 | qualsiasi | irgendeine | |
| 25 | marcio, -a | faul | |
| 26 | * | | |

## 3.6 Topics

If you organize your Excel workbooks in a directory structure below a main folder, you can specify this folder under **XLP | Preferences** as the "Folder for Excel Workbooks":




When adding links, this folder is then used as the starting location.

If you also select "Relative Path" under "Topic", the link list view displays only the links belonging to the folder selected above the list:

